



throughout the British Isles, particularly in Scotland, Ireland, and Wales, and many take great pride in their heritage and regional differences. There are scarcely any native speakers of Celtic languages such as

Irish, Scottish, Cornish, and Manx, though their study and use are actively promoted. Welsh too is in decline, although 20 percent of Welsh people speak it, and it is taught at many schools in Wales.



#### TOSSING THE CABER

The caber is long pole up to 18 ft (5.5 m) long and 150 lbs (70 kg) in weight. Competitors lift the caber and try to throw it in a straight line.

Tartan kilts (skirts) are the traditional costume of Scottish men.

#### PIPING IN THE HAGGIS

The Scots celebrate the birth of their greatest poet, Robert Burns, on January 25. Haggis, a traditional food made out of stuffed sheep's stomach is served at the meal. A great fuss is made over the haggis—it is brought in to the sound of a bagpipe, and speeches are made in its honor.

The haggis is stuffed with the heart and liver of a sheep and mixed with oatmeal and seasoning.



#### WHAT THE WELSH WORE

Welsh national costume is based on the clothes of Welsh peasants 200 years ago. For women and girls it consists of a striped petticoat worn under an open-fronted dress, called a bedgown, with an apron, shawl, and a tall hat. It is sometimes worn on Saint David's Day (March 1), Wales's national day.



#### SHEEP SHOW

Wales is the most important sheep farming region in Europe. There are 11 million sheep here alongside a human population of just three million. Sheep shows like this one allow farmers to come together to share news and information about sheep farming.

